

Μένανδρος ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Menander of Athens and the New Comedy of Human Affairs

eul_aid: hps

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κωμωδία Ἀττική [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: Κωμωδία [Comedy](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Menander was an Athenian comic playwright who lived from approximately 342 to 290 BCE during the Hellenistic period. He was born into a wealthy family and is said to have studied under Theophrastus, a philosopher and student of Aristotle. Menander was a friend of the governor Demetrius of Phaleron, an association that may have caused him political difficulty. According to ancient accounts, he died by drowning in the harbor of Piraeus.

He was the leading figure of New Comedy, a style that shifted focus from political satire to comedies about domestic life, romantic entanglements, and character types. Menander was extraordinarily prolific, credited with composing over 100 plays, though only titles survive for most. For centuries, his work was known mainly through fragments and Roman adaptations. This changed dramatically in the 20th century with major papyrus discoveries that recovered large portions of his plays.

His only complete surviving play is *Dyskolos*. Other significantly preserved works include *Samia*, *Aspis*, and *Epitrepontes*. According to modern scholars, Menander's historical importance is immense. His plays were celebrated in antiquity for their realistic characters, sophisticated plots, and use of everyday language. Roman playwrights Plautus and Terence adapted his works, making him a foundational influence on the Western comic tradition. The rediscovery of his texts has restored his reputation, allowing direct appreciation of his intricate storytelling and humane portraits of Athenian society.

Works (43)

- Φάντασμα · [Apparition](#) · 110 passages
- Διαιτησία · [Arbitration](#) · 897 passages
- Καρχηδόνιος · [Carthaginian](#) · 33 passages
- Κιθαριστής · [Citharist](#) · 74 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Κιθαριστῶν · [Citharists, Fragments Known Elsewhere](#) · 27 passages
- Κόλαξ · [Colax](#) · 132 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Κόλακος · [Colax, Fragments Known Elsewhere](#) · 19 passages
- Κονεαζόμεναι · [Coneazomenae](#) · 28 passages
- Διπλοῦς Ἀπατεῶν · [Double Deceiver](#) · 74 passages
- Ἀμφίβολον Ἀπόσπασμα · [Doubtful Fragment](#) · 17 passages
- Ἀμφίβολον Ἀπόσπασμα Θεοφορουμένης · [Dubious Theophorumenae Fragment](#) · 2 passages
- Δύσκολος · [Dyscolus](#) · 1188 passages

- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῆς Διαιτησίας · Fragments of Arbitration](#) · 14 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα Καρχηδονίων · Fragments of Carthaginians Known Elsewhere](#) · 11 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τοῦ Γεωργοῦ · Fragments of Georgus Known Elsewhere](#) · 24 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τοῦ Ἡρώος · Fragments of Hero Known Elsewhere](#) · 17 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τῆς Ἀσπίδος · Fragments of the Asp Known Elsewhere](#) · 4 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα τοῦ Διπλοῦ Ἀπατεῶνος · Fragments of the Double Deceiver Known Elsewhere](#) · 5 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Τύχης καὶ Ἀφροσύνης · Fragments on Fortune and Folly](#) · 26 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Οἴκου καὶ Τύχης · Fragments on Household and Fortune](#) · 36 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Πενίας καὶ Ἀγωγῆς · Fragments on Poverty and Conduct](#) · 1764 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Πενίας καὶ Πόνου · Fragments on Poverty and Labor](#) · 1659 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Πενίας καὶ Κοινωνικοῦ Βίου · Fragments on Poverty and Social Life](#) · 2118 passages
- [Γεωργός · Georgus](#) · 132 passages
- [Ἡ Κομφικεκαρμένη · Girl with Her Hair Cut Short](#) · 564 passages
- [Ἡρώς · Hero](#) · 116 passages
- [Μακρότερα Ἀποσπάσματα · Longer Fragments Preserved by Other Authors](#) · 264 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα · Menander's Comedic Fragments](#) · 247 passages
- [Μισούμενος · Misumenus](#) · 352 passages
- [Μισούμενος Ἀποσπάσματα · Misumenus Fragments](#) · 16 passages
- [Νέα Ἀποσπάσματα Μισουμένου · New Fragments of Misumenus](#) · 114 passages
- [Περίνθια · Perinthia](#) · 31 passages
- [Περίνθια Ἀποσπάσματα · Perinthia, Fragments Known from Elsewhere](#) · 17 passages
- [Σαμία · Samian Woman](#) · 1011 passages
- [Γνώμαι ἐκ Παπύρου · Sentences from Papyrus](#) · 31 passages
- [Ἀσπίς · Shield](#) · 643 passages
- [Σικυώνιος · Sicyonian](#) · 445 passages
- [Σικυώνιος Ἀποσπάσματα · Sicyonian Fragments Known Elsewhere](#) · 22 passages
- [Γνώμαι · Single-Line Sentences \(Long Recension\)](#) · 86 passages
- [Γνώμαι · Single-Line Sentences \(Short Recension\)](#) · 75 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα Θεοφορουμένης · Theophorumenae Fragments Known Elsewhere](#) · 17 passages
- [Θεοφορουμένη · Theophorumene](#) · 33 passages
- [Ἄδηλος Μῦθος · Uncertain Fable](#) · 87 passages